Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Chip Patina

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Chip Patina

Behind the portrait

Your stake tonight

Care is how he expresses affection. He can discuss a centuries-old crack more easily than guilt or grief.

During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Chip Patina

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*

2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*

3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He liked my name beneath his description. We had already argued over treatment paperwork. Then the entrance mount started moving. People sighed when I stopped the conversation. They always do. I am easier company if nobody touches anything. Claire knows that. Tonight I was exceptionally poor company.

IF MURDERER

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He had the insurance copy with the date I altered. Refusing his description meant answering for mine. Then the entrance mount started moving. He suggested I was inventing another problem to protect myself. Claire knows how I am about handling. Grant knew how to turn that into a joke.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I fitted the red closure band before the preview. Checked the closed bottle. Kept the condition sheet. Later I went to the alcove because the mount was moving. The treatment folder stayed at the workbench with the false date in it. Frank, your entrance could wait. Somebody underneath that mount could not.

IF MURDERER

I fitted the red band before the preview and kept the condition sheet. The copy with my false date was still at the workbench. After the preview I went to Grant's place to ask for that copy back. He wasn't there. The glass was. I held it up to the light: a shop engraving isn't a condition report. Put it back. Then Frank's mount started moving and I went to the alcove. Frank, I wanted that load down. The paper could wait. I told myself it could wait.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Red paper, silver backing. My supply sleeve has more of it. I fitted that band across the stopper and inspected from the front. Missed the split at the back. Both dates are in front of you: mine on the original, mine on the insurance copy. Yes, I changed one. Claire, leave the workbench alone until I can pack it. I know where every strip belongs. I don't want people taking pieces to pass around and asking me afterward what used to be there.

IF MURDERER

> My closure band was red woven tape. Foil-backed paper was packaging stock. The sleeve and technician's photograph concerned the band work. They weren't an inventory of every red scrap in the museum. The insurance date is wrong. I changed it. I can answer that question. I will not identify somebody else's packaging as a material I used.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not poison Grant. I changed an insurance date. I also put a foil-backed paper band on a closed bottle and missed the later split at its back. My original sheet and photograph remain. Claire, I will give you the keys to the workbench. I keep objects safe by refusing to let anyone near them. Tonight that instinct failed the people who trusted me.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The red band was foil-backed paper, exactly as the report says. I denied my own material because I had opened the bottle during the preview. I knew where its closure was weakest. Later I put the stolen poison in Grant's private glass. Its scrap and the damaged band belong to that sequence; they are not a unique fingerprint, and I hoped you would stop at that objection. The false date gave him leverage over me. I used the weakness in a closure I had fitted. People trusted my hands near things that could not be replaced. They should never trust them again.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.